Drain Pan



Category: **Automotive** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Drain pan

What it is used for

To collect used engine oil, coolant, or other automotive fluids during servicing using a suitable drain pan. To prevent spills and ensure fluids are handled and disposed of correctly.

Main parts

- Collection pan or basin
- Pouring lip or spout, if fitted
- Handles or grips
- Drain plug or tap, if fitted

Before you start

1. Select a pan with sufficient capacity for the fluid being drained.
2. Inspect the pan for cracks, leaks, and chemical compatibility.
3. Park the vehicle securely and follow the service manual isolation procedure.
4. Allow hot fluids to cool to a safe handling temperature where appropriate.
5. Wear suitable gloves and eye protection.

How to use

1. Position the pan directly below the drain point.
2. Confirm the pan is stable and can catch the full fluid stream.
3. Open the drain plug or valve according to the service procedure.
4. Allow the fluid to drain without splashing.
5. Reinstall the drain plug or close the valve to the specified requirement.
6. Transfer the collected fluid into a labelled, compatible waste container.
7. Clean spills promptly and dispose of waste through an approved channel.

⚠ Safety

- Avoid contact with hot fluids and moving vehicle parts.
- Never mix incompatible fluids or unknown chemicals.
- Prevent fluids from entering soil, drains, or watercourses.
- Use spill-control materials and follow hazardous-waste procedures.

Care & storage

- Empty and clean the pan after use using an approved method.

- Inspect for cracks and leaks before each use.
- Keep the pan dry and free from debris before storage.
- Store separately from clean-fluid containers.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using a pan with insufficient capacity.
- Positioning the pan away from the drain stream.
- Mixing different fluids in one container without authorization.
- Pouring used fluids into a drain or onto the ground.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.